



VIBRANT VIETNAM
The Huc Bridge: A
Must-See Attraction
in the Heart of Hanoi

A **SI BOARDED** Air India's maiden 4.5-hour flight from Delhi to Hanoi on May 1, there was a palpable sense of occasion in the air. At check-in, passengers were greeted with a dedicated counter, a celebratory photo booth, and a small goodie bag containing a Vietnamese handheld fan, and a commemorative plaque marking the inaugural flight. For many on board, it felt like the start of a new chapter in

Indian travel.

That excitement reflects a larger shift. Vietnam—long loved as a backpacker's paradise for its affordability, hostels, street food, and easy charm—is now drawing a more varied Indian traveller. It still offers value, but is also becoming more polished, with luxury hotels, premium flights, curated experiences, and Michelin-starred restaurants joining the familiar world of scooters, night markets, and bowls of *pho*.

Air India clearly sensed this shift. Two years after launching its service to Ho Chi Minh City, the airline added Hanoi to its Vietnam network, with a 5x weekly non-stop service. On the maiden flight, both Business Class and Premium Economy were sold out, a telling sign of the demand. "Vietnam has rapidly evolved into a high potential market for Indian travellers supported by strong leisure demand, growing business exchanges and rising interest in multi-city holidays," says Nipun Aggarwal, Chief Commercial Officer, Air India.

The welcome in Hanoi carried the same festive energy. As the aircraft landed, it received a water cannon salute—the ceremonial greeting reserved for special flights. Air India staff waited at the aerobridge, and the mood was celebratory.

Founded more than 1,000 years ago, Hanoi is one of South-east Asia's oldest capitals. The Old Quarter remains the city's beating heart. Dating back to the 14th century, it is a maze of narrow streets, colonial-era buildings, family-run businesses, food stalls, temples, cafés, and the constant hum of scooters. Walk here alone and you never feel lonely. Vendors call out, monks pass through lanes, and the scent of *pho* drifts around every corner.

For Indian travellers, this mix has become increasingly attractive. Nearly four hundred thousand Indians visited Vietnam in 2024. Rajesh Magow, Co-Founder and Group CEO of online travel-booking platform MakeMyTrip, describes Vietnam as "one of the most exciting stories in Indian outbound travel," adding that it now ranks